About the Department.

- The Co-operation Department is listed as one of the Administrative under the Government of Meghalaya at the Secretariat Level normally confines itself to general policy direction, Legislation assembly business, inter – departmental matters and review and assessment of execution of policies and Schemes.

- The office of the Registrar of Cooperative Societies is a Directorate under the Co-operation Department headed by the Registrar of Cooperative Societies borne from IAS cadre with day to day execution, routine administration and implementation of its policies and schemes.

- The Meghalaya Cooperative Societies Act 2015 (Act No. 11 of 2015) which came into effect from 1st December, 2015 empowers the Registrar of Cooperative Societies for the purpose of registration, supervision, control, management, conduct of statutory audit for accountability and transparency besides supporting the deserving Cooperative Societies for their over-all growth and development.

- To bring the administration closer to the people most of the powers of the Registrar of Cooperative Societies have been delegated to the Assistant Registrar of Cooperative societies at the District Level and the Sub-Registrar of Cooperative Societies at the Sub-Divisional level supported by field officers in the rank of Senior Cooperative Officers and Junior Cooperative Officers.

The present position of the Department may be mentioned below:

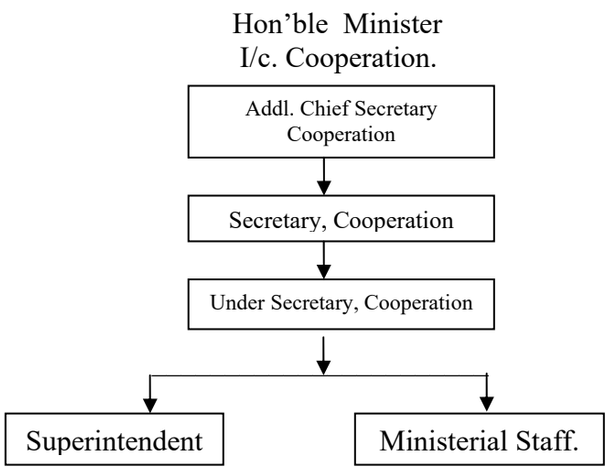
1.	District Offices	:	7(seven)
2.	Sub-Divisional Offices	:	3(three) inclusive of the newly created District of South West Khasi Hills District.
3.	Zonal Office	:	1(one) in West Garo Hills District.
4.	Training Institute	:	1(one) Meghalaya Cooperative Training Institute, Nongrim Hills, Shillong.

The Department has proposed for upgradation of 1(one) Sub-Divisional office into a District for the newly created South West Khasi Hills District and to open 3(three) District Offices for the newly created District of North Garo Hills District, South West Garo Hills District and East Jaintia Hills District. Meghalaya.

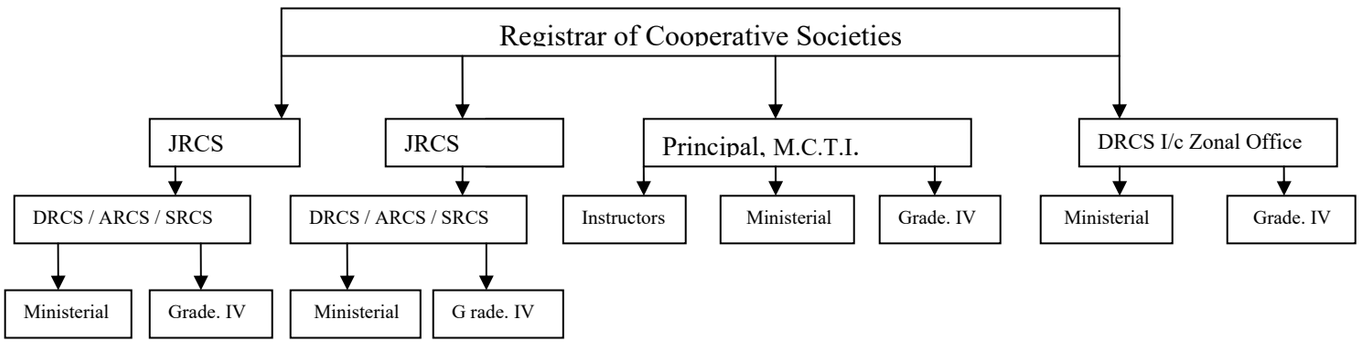
1. Structure of the Department.

I. Administrative Level:

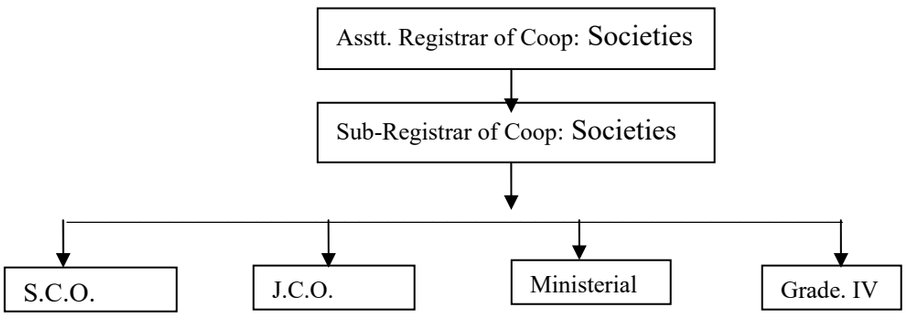
The present structure of the Administrative Department:



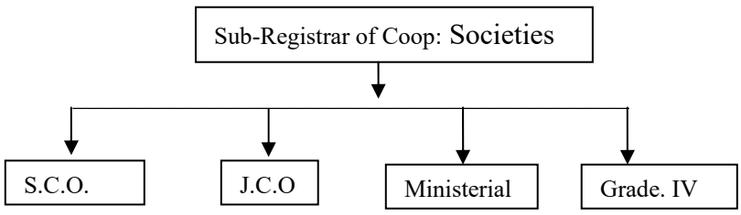
II. Directorate Level :



III. District Level :



IV. Sub-Divisional Level :



Present Strength of the office of the Registrar of Cooperative Societies as on 30.09.2016.

Sl. No.	Designations	Strength	Of which temporary	In-position	Remarks.
1.	Registrar of Cooperative Societies Borne on I.A.S. cadre	1		1	
2.	Joint Registrar of Coop: Societies	2		1	
3.	Principal, Meghalaya Coop: Training Institute in the rank of Joint Registrar of Coop: Societies	1		-	
4.	Deputy Registrar of Coop: Societies	2	1	1	
5.	Deputy Registrar of Coop: Societies Incharge Zonal Office, Tura.	1		1	
6.	Asstt. Registrar of Coop: Societies	10	2	10	
7.	Sub- Registrar of Coop: Societies	15	3	15	
8.	Senior Coop: Officers	73	12	68	
9.	Junior Coop: Officers	101	16	73	
	Total:				

Total Registered Cooperative Societies as on 31-03-2016.

Sl.No.	Type/Sector of Cooperative Societies	Number of Cooperative Societies	Membership		
			Male	Female	Total
1	State Level Cooperative Societies	6			22,285
	Primary Cooperative Societies				
2	Cooperative Urban Banks	3	7,282	6,425	13,707
3	PrimaryAgricultural Credit Societies (PACS)	179	58,754	23,490	82,244
4	Marketing	28	1,094	128	1,222
5	Consumer	53	5,258	1,259	6,517
6	Dairy	88	2,316	518	2,834
7	Fisheries	70	1,948	474	2,422
8	Piggery, Poultry & other Livestock	77	869	699	1,568
9	Handloom Weavers	71	556	3,826	4,382
10	Transport	67	1,599	604	2,203
11	Industrial	106	2,038	616	2,654
12	Processing	15	369	117	486
13	Integrated Village Cooperative Societies	54	2,088	1,129	3,217
14	Thrift & Mutual Benefit Fund Cooperative Societies	64	11,028	4,004	15,032
15	Multipurpose	503	7,854	5,313	13,167
16	Tourism	10	219	42	261
17	Handicrafts	11	81	197	278
18	Other Types	106	2,730	1,560	4,290
	TOTAL :	**1,511**	**1,06,083**	**50,401**	**1,78,769**

2. Aims and Objectives.

The Co-operation Department, Govt. of Meghalaya after its bifurcation from the erstwhile State of Assam in the year 1972 is striving towards making the Cooperative Movement in the State stronger and more vibrant. There is a growing realization and genuine desires among the members / promoters of the Cooperative Societies to make the Cooperative Societies vibrant units of economic activities capable of Meeting their felt needs of the members in particular and the Cooperative society in general.

The objective of the Department is to promote Cooperative Societies as an effective instrument for socio-economic growth centers and functions as a catalyst for spontaneous and voluntary participation of the people especially in the field of Rural Development.

To facilitate Cooperation Education, Awareness and Motivational programmes on the values and principles of Cooperation for a strong and effective Cooperative Movement.

Furtherance, the aim and objectives, the Department has taken up the following initiatives:

- Strengthening the training infrastructure for the Cooperative sector.
- Formation of Integrated Village Cooperative Societies (IVCS) for the Villages where no suitable existing community institutions or PACs exist for agriculture and agri-allied development financial inclusion, access to market linkages in collaboration with Meghalaya Livelihood and Access to market Project (Megha LAMP) on IFAD funded project.
- Face changing on-line adoption of Data base system for Cooperative Societies.
- Restructuring the Department for development of Rural Tourism/diversification of activities for livelihood programme by Cooperative Societies in the villages.
- Closer co-ordination with concerned line Department for specialized training and technical support to Departmental Officers.
- Guidance for establishing market linkages and creation of value chain.

The Departmental thrust has been towards the following:-

- Increasing membership drive.
- Organizing Awareness programme.
- Importing service development programme.
- To improve forward and backward marketing linkages.
- To develop value chain in respect to indigenous and specialized products.
- Enhance co-ordination with sectoral nodal departments like Agriculture, Horticulture, Sericulture, Animal Husbandry and Veterinary, Industries etc for development of respective sector Cooperatives.
- Work in close co-ordination with Meghalaya Integrated Basin Development Livelihood Programme (MIBDLP) and Meghalaya Access to Market Projects (MeghaLAMP).

3. Functions :

Sl. No.	Level	Functions
1.	**Administrative Level**	The Department functions with the Rules of extensive business of the State of Meghalaya framed under 2&3 of Article 166 of the constitution of India. The Administrative roles, powers and functions are also guided by the Meghalaya Secretariat Manual of office procedure, the General Handbook of circulars, the Fundamental and subsidiary Rules, 1984 and other Rules and Regulations adopted/enacted from time to time in the Government and such subordinate legislations as may be relevant to the functioning of the Department including the Delegation of Financial Power Rules, 1981. i) Policy decisions. ii) Approval and sanctions of Schemes. iii) Administrative Directions, Assembly business, inter-departmental matters. iv) Review and assessment of execution of policies and v) schemes. vi) Promotions and transfer of Gazzetted Officers from the rank of Sub-Registrar of Cooperative Societies to the rank of Joint Registrar of Cooperative Societies. vii) Sanction of Leave for Gazzetted Officers.
2.	**Directorate Level**	The regulation and control of the Cooperative Societies are governed by the Meghalaya Cooperative Societies Act and Rules. The Registrar of Cooperative Societies holds the key position in the State. He is the statutory authority for registering Cooperative Societies and administering the Law governing Cooperative Societies. The Registrar of Cooperative Societies appointed by the Government of Meghalaya for the registration, supervision, assistance, counsel of registered Cooperative Societies including Arbitration, Audit, liquidation of Cooperative Societies and for over-all development of the Cooperative Movement and to promote all Cooperative education and with such other powers and responsibilities has already been provided in the Meghalaya Cooperative Societies Act & Rules. Besides the above, the function of the Department headed by the Registrar of Cooperative Societies can be enumerated as below: i) Inquiry and Inspection. ii) Settlement of dispute. iii) Recovery of sum dues and enforcement of obligations. iv) Sanction and release of Financial Assistance to Cooperative Societies. v) Amalgamation/Conversion of Cooperative Societies. vi) Liquidation of Cooperative Societies. vii) Regulate the activities and function of all the State level and Primary Level Cooperatives. viii) Cause Inquiry and Inspection of Cooperative Societies as per provisions of the Act and Rules. ix) General Direction and Administration of the Department and its subordinate Offices, Cooperative Societies, Officers and staff such as: a. Appointment of Junior Cooperative Officer, L.D.A., Typist and Grade-IV employees. b. Con troll and supervision of all the District

		office and Sub-Divisional Offices. c. Monitoring and review the implementation of State Plan Schemes, Non-Plan, Central Sector, Scheme, centrally sponsored Schemes of all the State Level and Primary Cooperative Societies in the State. d. Transfer and posting of Senior/Junior Cooperative Officers. e. Confirmation of service of Senior/Junior Cooperative Officers, Ministerial staff and Grade-IV employees. x) Delegation of Financial Powers to the Subordinate offices at the District and Sub-Divisional Level. xi) For the purpose under the Right to Information Act, 2015, the Registrar of Cooperative Societies is the Public Authority of the Department.
3.	**District and Sub-ordinate Establishment.**	The Registrar of Cooperative Societies have three types of Powers viz., Administrative, Financial and statutory. He is assisted by a team of officials in the Department at District and Subordinate establishment as well as on the fields to promote, regulate, supervise, audit and control the Cooperatives. He delegated these powers to his / her team of officials so that they exercise these powers in their area of jurisdiction. **(i)** The Deputy Registrar of Cooperative Societies I/c Zonal Office is posted at Tura. He exercised control and supervision of all the 3(three) District offices in Garo Hills region as well over the registered Primary Level Cooperative Societies and branches of State Level Cooperative Federations as entrusted to him / her under the Cooperative Societies Act and Rules need also the powers delegated by the Registrar of Cooperative Societies. **(ii)** The Assistant Registrar of Cooperative Societies are posted in the districts as District Officers. They are to exercise control and supervision over the Primary Level Cooperative Societies as well as branches of State Level Cooperative Institutions within their districts. They are also to discharge in statutory functions as entrusted upon them under the Cooperative Societies Act and Rules need also the powers delegated by the Registrar of Cooperative Societies. The organization/ registration of Cooperative Societies, Audit and Inspection, supervision and guidance and also in every step of functions at the Primary level Cooperative Societies which are the main functions of the Assistant Registrar of Cooperative Societies as incharge of district. The District offices need to redress arbitration, disputes etc between Cooperative Societies according to the provisions laid down in the Meghalaya Cooperative Societies Act and Rules framed there under in the court maintains in the District offices. Apart from statutory powers, the District officer has also to function as per the financial powers delegated by the Registrar of Cooperative Societies as a Drawing and disbursing Officer, transfer and posting of Officers within his jurisdiction, sanction of Leave and advances to his officer and Ministerial staff and attend the Meeting, workshops, seminars of the development departments and the head of the District. **(iii)** The Sub-Registrar of Cooperative Societies are posted in the District to assist the Assistant Registrar of Cooperative Societies in discharging of his functions

		with special reference in the matters relating to preparation of annual programme for statutory Audit, review and progress of audit and submission of Balance Sheet – scrutiny of audit notes for rectification of defects, initiation of action both Civil and criminal for misappropriation and misutilization of funds, scrutiny of realized profits and distribution thereof, assessment and realization of audit fee etc. of all the registered Cooperative Societies in the district and assist the Assistant Registrar of Cooperative Societies in the matter of Inspection, Supervision and guidance for the Primary Level Cooperative Societies. **(iv)** The Sub-Registrar of Cooperative Societies posted in the Sub-Divisions are to exercise the powers and functions as entrusted to the Assistant Registrar of Cooperative societies at the District level and functions independently except in other policies matters which need the sanction and approval at the District Level. He is also to co-ordinate with all the development departments at the Sub-Division and to the head of the Sub-Division. **(v)** The Officers in the rank of Senior Cooperative Officers posted in the District/ Sub-Divisions Offices are entrusted to do all the field works like organization of different types of Cooperative Societies, Inspection and Audit of all registered Cooperative Societies which in turn involves the completion of final account of the Cooperative Societies. They are also required to assist the Cooperative Societies for preparation of their annual budget, facilitation of various economic livelihood schemes for the Cooperative Societies through the development departments. Further, the Senior Cooperative Officers do have additional responsibility at/or could be deputed to CEO (Circle Extension Officer) at the Block Level. This responsibility entails coordination of Cooperative Societies at the Block Level, assisting the same and coordinating with the BDOs and the other line department as the need arise. **(vi)** The Officers in the rank of Junior Cooperative Officers posted in the District/ Sub-Divisions Offices are entrusted to do all the field works like organization of different types of Cooperative Societies, Inspection and Audit of all registered Cooperative Societies which is turn involves the completion of final account of the Cooperative Societies. They are also required to assist the Cooperative Societies for preparation of their annual budget, facilitation of various economic livelihood schemes for the Cooperative Societies through the development departments. 1(one) Senior Cooperative Officer from each district/sub-division are appointed as Liquidation-Cum-Bakijai Officer and at least 4(four) to 5(five) Officers are posted in circles coterminous with C&RD Blocks as Cooperative Extension Officers for supervision and control of the registered Cooperative Societies in the Circle. Newly recruited Junior Cooperative Officers are also attached to Senior Cooperative Officers at the Circles to assist the Cooperative Extension officers and for Audit of Cooperative Societies.